Nhill 2.1 — User guide

Français : ../fr/guide-utilisateur.md

Part	Application	For	Platforms
A	**Nhill Business**	the business: sales, customers, stock, purchases, expenses, reports, team	Windows, Linux, Android
B	**Nhill Console**	the creators of Nhill (private application)	Windows, Linux
C	**Nhill POS**	the cashiers of a business	Windows, Linux

Screenshots: `docs/captures/` (taken on version 0.1.0; the 2.0 screens keep the same layout, with the improvements listed in § 0). The applications are available in French and English; the labels below are the English ones.

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0. What is new for users

Version 2.1

- **Remember me** (Nhill Business and Nhill POS, on Windows, Linux and Android): when ticked at sign-in, the application reopens already signed in. Only a session token is kept, in the system's secure storage (Windows Credential Manager, Android Keystore, Linux keyring), **never the password**. Unticked, nothing is kept; signing out also erases the remembered session (§ 10).
- **Forgotten password**: the establishment's administrator gives an employee a temporary password; owners and administrators receive a code by e-mail (§ 9).

Version 2.0

- **Passwords**: at least 8 characters everywhere (account creation, invitation, password change, reset, administration console). Very common passwords ("12345678", "password", "kinshasa"…) are refused. No periodic change is required; change it only if you think it was seen or guessed.
- **Show password**: an eye button in every password field shows or hides what you type (useful on phones).
- **Windows that fit the screen**: on start, each application takes a size suited to the screen (small laptop screens included) and is centred; on a screen that is too small it opens maximised. Windows can be resized freely.
- **Tables**: horizontal scrolling when the columns do not fit, tooltip on truncated text, keyboard navigation (arrows, Enter).
- **Accessibility**: stronger contrast (secondary text, field borders, disabled buttons), visible keyboard focus ring, tooltips on icon buttons, error messages shown longer (8 s) and announced to screen readers.
- **Nhill POS**: `F2` puts the cursor in the search / barcode field, `F9` opens payment; − / + buttons for quantities; layout adapted to narrow screens; closing requires the counted amount.

Part A — Nhill Business

1. First start

The **Welcome** screen offers two choices.

1.1 “My business already exists” (join)

1. Enter the **establishment code** (`NH-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX`) given by the owner. The code changes automatically every 30 days: if it is refused, ask for the new one. The error message is deliberately the same in every case.
2. The code is not enough: either **“I have an account”** (your e-mail and password) or **“I received an invitation”** (the invitation e-mail, the 8-digit activation code given by your manager, and a password of at least 8 characters that you choose).

1.2 “Create my business”

1. **Type of activity**: *Sole trader* (one user, simplified screens) or *Company or organisation* (several users, roles, invitations).
2. **Identity**: trade name, legal name, sector, country, VAT registration, legal identifiers (RCCM, national ID, tax number… only those that apply to you).
3. **Contact details and preferences**: city, address, phone, e-mail, main currency, document language.
4. **Your account** (owner, password of at least 8 characters), then **review and create**.

The free trial (30 days by default) starts without any payment method. Write down the **establishment code** shown at the end. If a business with the same legal identifier already exists, Nhill never links you to it automatically: you can send a **link request**, checked by the owner or by support.

2. Main screen

Side menu (drawer on phones, scrollable when the window is short): Dashboard, Sales, Customers and suppliers, Products and services, Stock, Purchases, Expenses, Payments, Reports, Activity log (or My activity), Settings. At the top: global search (`Ctrl+K`), connection status (Online / Offline / Server problem), subscription status, notifications.

Shortcut	Action
`Ctrl+K`	global search
`Ctrl+N`	new invoice (if your role allows it)
`Ctrl+1` … `Ctrl+4`	Dashboard, Sales, Customers, Products
`F5`	refresh the screen
`Alt+←` (Back key)	previous screen
`Tab` / `Shift+Tab`	next / previous field (also inside text areas)

Light, dark or automatic theme and language (French/English): Settings › My account.

3. Sales

- **New invoice** (or quote, order): customer, currency, date, due date, lines (product or free line, quantity, price before tax, discount, tax). The total shown is an estimate; the server recalculates and its figure is authoritative.
- **Save draft**: editable, no number, “DRAFT” watermark on the PDF.
- **Issue**: the invoice gets its **final number** (e.g. `FA-2026-000012`), stock goes down, and it **can no longer be edited or deleted**. To correct it: **Credit note** (full or partial, with optional return to stock).
- **Foreign-currency document**: an exchange rate is asked for at issue; it is stored with its date and source and never recalculated.

- **Connection lost while issuing or recording a payment**: a banner offers **Retry**. The operation will never be recorded twice.
- **Quote**: Send → Accepted / Declined → Convert to invoice. **Order**: Confirm → Convert to invoice.
- **Payment**: from the invoice, "Record a payment" (cash, Mobile Money, card, transfer, cheque..., reference). The amount cannot exceed the balance due.
- **PDF**: PDF button; the file is saved in `Downloads/Nhill` and opened.
- **DRC, VAT-registered**: Nhill documents are **management documents**, not standardised invoices. Issue the standardised invoice with the electronic tax device required by the DGI, then use "Record DEF reference" on the Nhill invoice for reconciliation (see `docs/en/legal-parameters.md`).

4. Customers, products, stock, purchases, expenses

- **Customers and suppliers**: contact details, tax number, payment terms, internal notes; the record shows the balance and documents.
- **Products and services**: reference, name, unit, sale and purchase price, tax, alert threshold. CSV import/export (`;`): import is **all or nothing** (errors are listed per line and nothing is imported while any remain).
- **Stock**: quantities change **only through movements** (sale, purchase, credit note, adjustment with a mandatory reason, transfer between warehouses depending on the plan). Movements tab: full history with the author.
- **Purchases**: draft → **Receive goods** (stock in, purchase price updated) → payment.
- **Expenses**: amount including tax, deductible tax, category, supplier, paid or not, **receipt** (PDF/PNG/JPEG, 5 MB).

5. Reports

Sales journal (with "Issued by"), activity per employee, payments (with "Recorded by"), expenses, sales per product (margin **estimated** at the current purchase price), stock movements, receivables and payables to date. Any period, export to **CSV** or **PDF**. Amounts are always shown **per currency**, never converted or added across currencies.

6. Who did what — activity log

- **Owner, administrator, accountant**: *Activity log* — every action in the business (sign-ins, documents, payments, stock, products, contacts, team, settings, till, Nhill support interventions), with date, author, object and details. Filters by **employee**, **action type** (including "Till" and "Nhill support" in 2.0) and **period**; **CSV/PDF** export. Clicking a line opens the document concerned.
- **"Activity per employee" report**: for each person and currency, documents created, invoices and credit notes issued, amounts collected, expenses entered, stock corrections and last activity.
- **Other roles**: *My activity* — only their own actions.
- The log is kept by the server and **can be neither edited nor erased**, not even by the owner. Tell your staff about it.

7. Settings

Tab	Content	Who
Business	Identity, legal identifiers, **logo**, document language, payment terms, tax rounding, payment instructions, footer, negative stock	Owner, administrator

Tab	Content	Who
Establishment code	Show/hide, copy, **renew now**	Owner, administrator, manager (read)
Team	Members, roles, deactivation, **invitations** (activation code shown **only once**: hand it over in person, by phone or SMS), **password reset** of a member (§ 9)	Owner, administrator
Subscription	Plan, end date, plans by duration and currency, promo code, payment, history	Owner, administrator
Taxes and accounts	Tax rates (cannot be edited: create a new code), cash and bank accounts, **exchange rates**	Owner, administrator
Point of sale	Tills and cashiers, payment methods, maximum discount, receipt, till promo codes, sessions and X/Z reports	Owner, administrator; manager and accountant: sessions and reports
My account	Name, phone, language, theme, **password** (changing it signs out your other devices), **Remember me on this device**, sign out	Everyone

Roles: **Owner**, **Administrator**, **Manager**, **Sales / cashier**, **Accountant**, **Till supervisor**, **Cashier**, **Read only**.

8. Subscription (owner and administrators)

- Free trial (30 days by default, once per business).
- **Choose a plan**: duration and currency offered by Nhill, then **Choose this plan**. The summary computed by the server shows the price, any discount, the prorated credit and the total.
- **Upgrade**: immediate, unused part deducted. **Downgrade**: applied at the end of the period. **Renewal**: no day is lost.
- **Payment**: card or PayPal when Nhill has enabled them, otherwise bank transfer / Mobile Money with the reference shown, confirmed by the billing team. The subscription changes when the payment is confirmed, never before. An unpaid request expires after 48 hours.
- After the grace period without payment: **read only** (viewing and export remain possible).

9. Help and support

Help and support menu: send a question or a bug report to the Nhill team and follow the answers. Never include a password, an establishment code or a card number.

Forgotten password

The Nhill team does not know your password and will never ask for it. Depending on your role:

You are an employee (sales, cashier, accountant, manager…). Ask the administrator or the owner of your establishment. In **Settings › Team**, they choose your name, then **Reset the password**: Nhill creates a temporary password (12 characters, for example `k7Rm-x2Qa-Hp9w`), shown **only once**, which they give you **in person or by phone** (never by e-mail or in a group chat). Your open sessions are closed immediately. At your next sign-in with this temporary password, Nhill asks you to choose a new one (at least 8 characters, different from the temporary one) before opening the application. The temporary password expires after 72 hours: after that, ask for another one.

An administrator can only reset accounts of **their** establishment, never the owner's nor their own; only the owner can reset an administrator. If your account is also used in **another** business, none of its administrators can reset it: use the e-mail procedure below.

You are the owner or an administrator (or your account is used in several businesses). On the sign-in screen, choose **Forgot your password?**, enter your e-mail address, then **Send the code**. You receive an 8-digit code (`1234-5678`), valid for **20 minutes** and usable **once**; enter it with your new password. After 5 wrong codes the code is cancelled: ask for a new one. A new request cancels the previous code. The message shown is the same whether or not the address matches an account (so nobody can find out who uses Nhill); if yours is an employee account, the e-mail you receive tells you whom to contact. Once the password is changed, **all your sessions are closed** and an e-mail informs you of the change.

Changing your password while signed in remains possible (Settings › My account).

10. Sign-in and security

- **Remember me**: tick it at sign-in, only on a device you do not share. The application then reopens signed in; the session token is kept in the system's secure storage (Windows Credential Manager, Android Keystore, Secret Service or KWallet keyring on Linux), never in plain text and never the password. **Signing out** erases this session; unticking the option (at sign-in or in Settings › My account) erases it too. If the system refuses to keep it (for example Linux without a keyring), the application says so and will ask you to sign in again.
- Lost or stolen device: change your password from another device (every other session is closed) or ask your administrator to reset your access.
- Offline: viewing and writing are suspended; nothing is lost.
- Several businesses with the same account: choose at sign-in.
- After several wrong sign-in attempts, the server slows further attempts down.

11. Scope of Nhill (to know before deciding)

The website presents these points positively; here is their exact wording.

Topic	What Nhill does	What it does not do
Tax obligations	tax rates, legal identifiers and mentions on every document; `CD` profile (DRC, draft to be validated by a tax adviser) and generic `INTL` profile; reference of an official document (for example the DGI DEF) recorded on the Nhill invoice	is **certified in no country**: not a certified till, not regulatory e-invoicing, not a fiscal device
Accounting	journals and CSV/PDF exports (sales, payments, expenses, receivables, amounts to pay)	does not keep the general ledger (OHADA chart of accounts)
Payments	cash, card, bank transfer, cheque, Mobile Money recorded with their reference	not connected to Mobile Money operators or card terminals: the payment is checked on the phone or terminal
Sending documents	PDFs to share from the computer or phone	no direct sending by e-mail or SMS from the application
Connection	a mobile connection is enough; an interrupted sale is sent again without duplicate	without a connection, you can neither sell nor invoice
Devices	Nhill Business: Windows, Linux, Android; Nhill POS: Windows, Linux	no till on Android or iOS

Part B — Nhill Console (creators)

Separate application, reserved for the creators of Nhill. Every action is written to the audit log. The console gives **no access to the invoices, customers or stock** of the businesses.

1. Access

- **Install a new server** (once): see the installation guide § 4.
- **First access**: e-mail, **initialisation token** (valid 30 minutes), password of **at least 8 characters**, then add the key to an authenticator app (TOTP) and enter a 6-digit code. Two-factor authentication remains **mandatory** for the console (it gives access to the whole platform); a long passphrase is recommended.
- **Sign-in**: e-mail + password + TOTP code (each code works once). The session is not remembered.
- Roles: **superadmin**, **billing** (plans, payments, reports), **support** (businesses, suspensions, codes, link requests, announcements), **auditor** (read only: log, statistics, provider events).

2. Screens

Screen	Use
Overview	Businesses, subscriptions by state, active users, 30-day activity, confirmed revenue
Businesses	Search; record: identity, subscription, codes (without their value), statistics; **Suspend / Reactivate / Reissue code**, **Subscription…** — reason required
Reports	Global report per business and currency — CSV/PDF
Link requests	Check identity, accept/decline with a note
Notifications	Support, payments received or mismatched, technical errors
Support requests	Take, answer, internal note, change state
Transactions	Payment requests, reconciliation, **manual confirmation** of a transfer (reference + reason)
Plans and prices	Plans, limits and **prices per duration and currency** (no hard-coded price)
Promo codes	Percentage or amount, dates, uses, eligible plans
Payment providers	Stripe, PayPal, Payoneer (configuration only), generic; secrets **encrypted, never shown again**; test/production mode
Technical errors	Grouped errors, to mark as resolved
Audit log	Platform and security events
Announcements	Messages to businesses
Platform settings	Trial, grace, code rotation, limits; invite an administrator

A business's **statistics** are aggregates computed by the database; no customer name, product or document number is transmitted, and every view appears in the business's log.

Part C — Nhill POS (till)

Linked to a Nhill Business establishment: same products, prices, taxes and stock. Each cashier signs in with **their own account** (Cashier or Till supervisor role).

1. Prepare (Nhill Business → Settings → Point of sale)

1. **New till**: code printed on receipts (e.g. `C1`), name, location, warehouse.
2. **Who can open this till**: tick the cashiers.
3. **Payment methods**: Cash (automatic), Card, M-Pesa… Nhill records the amount; it does not drive card terminals or mobile operators.
4. **Rules and receipt**: maximum discount without approval, width (58/80 mm), message.
5. **Till promo codes**.

2. Open the till

Sign in, choose the till, **count the opening float**, **Open the session**. “Remember me” and “Forgot your password?” work as in Nhill Business (Part A, § 9 and § 10); on a till computer shared by several cashiers, leave “Remember me” unticked.

3. Sell

Key / button	Action
`F2`	go to search / barcode
Enter (after a barcode)	add the product
– / +	decrease / increase a line’s quantity
`%`	line discount
`F9` or **Pay**	open payment

- One or several payment methods; for cash, enter the **amount tendered**: the change is shown. **Print the receipt** (roll-format PDF).
- Above the allowed discount, a supervisor enters **their own** e-mail and password; the approval works once and is logged.
- Network cut during validation: press Validate again; the sale will not be recorded twice.
- Narrow screen: the ticket moves below the product grid.

4. Receipts, returns, cancellations, cash

Receipts and till: list of the session’s receipts (“Date / time” column), totals, sales per payment method.

- On a receipt: **Print**, **Return quantities** or **Cancel the receipt** (same session). Reason required; supervisor approval if needed.
- **Cash in / out**; cash out cannot exceed the cash present.
- **X reading**: interim report without closing.

5. Close

Close the till: count the drawer (amount **required**) and enter the terminal totals. The cashier does not see the expected amount; the server computes the difference. The **Z report** can then be downloaded; a closed session can no longer be changed. Differences are notified to supervisors.

Receipts are management documents; Nhill POS is not a certified till.